BIGOLI IN SALSA

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**1 h 30 min plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Whole-wheat dough
56 g	Olive oil
45 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
454 g	Onions, finely diced
15 g	Garlic, finely chopped
114 g	Oil-packed anchovy fillets, finely chopped
120 g	Water
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Make 624 g of bigoli from the whole-wheat dough.
2. Put a large saute pan on low heat. Add the butter and the oil and swirl them into an emulsion.
3. Stir in the onions and give them 5 to 8 minutes to start softening.
4. Add the garlic, anchovies and water. Cook 45 minutes to 1 hour, stirring often, until the onions have caramelized to a deep golden brown. Set the pan aside.
5. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to a boil over high heat.
6. Cook the bigoli 2 to 3 minutes. They want to be tender, not soft.
7. Return the saute pan to low heat. Lift the pasta across with tongs or a pasta basket, raise the heat to medium, and toss 1 to 2 minutes, feeding in about 2 ladles of pasta water (115 g) as you go. A splash more loosens the sauce if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
8. Divide between bowls and grind black pepper over the top.

NOTES

> The point of the long, low cook is that the anchovies and onions dissolve into something creamy. Rushing it on higher heat gives you fried onion and whole anchovy instead.
> Sardines stand in for the anchovies in some versions, notably around Mantua.
> The dough is whole-wheat, not egg. Bigoli is a thick spaghetti and the wholemeal grain is what the sauce is built against.
> The 114 g of anchovy is 20 to 24 fillets, which is less alarming than it sounds once they have melted into the onion.
> Black pepper is a late addition to the traditional version and the bite is what keeps the sweetness in check.

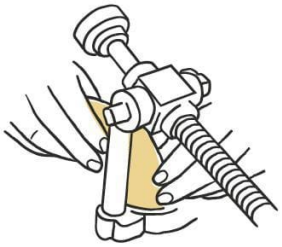
SHAPE
Bigoli

Region: The Veneto, especially Venice; Istria; southeastern Lombardy around Mantua / Rest: 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature

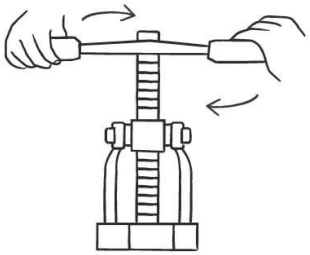
METHOD

1. Make the whole-wheat dough.
2. Dust a wooden work surface lightly with 00 flour. Set out a parchment-lined sheet pan, dusted lightly with semolina. Clamp the bigolaro to the edge of the work surface.
3. Quarter the dough. Keep three pieces under plastic wrap or a towel and work with one.
4. Roll the piece into a cylinder roughly 2 inches across, sized to drop into the bigolaro chamber.
5. Load the cylinder and turn the lever to extrude. Cut the strands to 12 inches with a knife.
6. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour and shake them gently apart. Curl each batch into a horseshoe and set it on the pan.
7. Repeat with the remaining quarters.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, wrap the pan and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

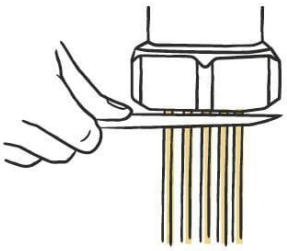
SHAPING



1



2



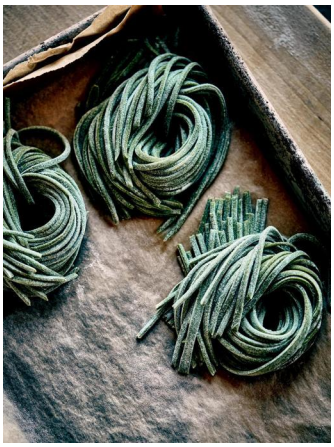
3



4



5



6

NOTES

Requires a bigolaro — a tabletop hand press clamped to the work surface, worked by a lever, that forces the dough out as long thick strands.
Dough cylinder about 2 inches in diameter; the chamber sets the limit.
Strands cut to 12 inches by hand.
Whole-wheat dough. The book blends whole-wheat or buckwheat flour with 00 rather than using the alternative flour alone, and leaves out the butter and milk that some versions include, on the grounds that both cost the pasta its bite.
Similar to pici, but extruded rather than hand-rolled. Called fusarioi in Istria.
Keeps refrigerated up to 24 hours.
Served with anchovy and onion sauce in the Venetian manner, sardine and onion around Mantua, or rich meat sauces.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

_____